

Maksim Ganyushin

QA Lead and engineer: autonomous transport, robotics, AI services

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Full-time • On-site/Remote • Open to business trips

Profile

16 years in IT, eight of them testing autonomous systems. At Yandex I grew from engineer to head of the self-driving car testing department, which prepared the first rides with no driver behind the wheel in Innopolis and Moscow. For the past year and a half I have been building software for Yandex's educational robots, from firmware to factory acceptance, and developing the amiok.pro health-data service.

Work Experience

Jun 2026 — Present

Founder

Am I OK (amiok.pro) • wellness service: your whole health picture in one place

- Launched a service that reads lab results from photos and PDFs, collects data from wearable trackers, shows how values change over time and suggests what to improve.
- Deployed a language model on my own servers (vLLM) so medical data never leaves the service's environment.
- Added RAG: before answering, the model receives passages from a medical knowledge base, which cuts hallucinations.
- Trained a LoRA on top of SDXL for the characters and quests section; I accept generations against reference metrics.
- Quality system: automated tests at every level, from units to in-browser scenarios (pytest, Vitest, Playwright); every release is checked on the live site and rolled back automatically on failure.
- Stack: React, Django, PostgreSQL, Docker; CI/CD on GitHub with automated tests on a separate test server.

Jun 2025 — Present

Software for educational robots and robotics competitions

Sole proprietor, turnkey project in partnership with Yandex • Moscow

- Develop the on-robot software of the series-production robot for Yandex's educational platform: firmware for both processors (ESP32-S3 and GD32), motion, camera, audio, sensors, Bluetooth and Wi-Fi.
- Take part in hardware reviews and in agreeing the protocol between the robot and the platform.
- Prepared an acceptance stand for the assembly line: every robot goes through an automated stress test, and the results are stored in the robot's memory and mirrored to an external server.
- Hardware-free firmware tests: the interpreter and the protocol are tested on a computer, and the BLE contract and the platform's command set are checked automatically in CI.
- For the Yandex Education Cup, assembled and tuned the robots and built a web platform for training a neural network and a simulator with a map editor. The code is open on GitHub.
- Together with Yandex Education and RoboFinist we ran the final of the Robo-Delivery competition for students aged 12–15; I worked on the rules, the field and the judging criteria.

Aug 2024 — Apr 2025

QA Engineer

JSC KAMA (ATOM) • Moscow

- Set up the release process and ADAS function testing together with adjacent departments.
- Passed the ASPICE audit and, together with the team, reworked the testing processes to follow its recommendations.
- Introduced automated tests and quality metrics for vehicle functions.
- Prepared and ran the Moscow–Kazan test drive, then organized trials and quality assessment of the technology.

May 2018 — Aug 2024

Head of Self-Driving Car Testing

Yandex • Moscow

- Grew from QA engineer to head of the department.
- The department tested a fleet that at its peak numbered 120 self-driving cars and about 300 delivery robots.
- Together with the team, built the release cycle and cut it from a month to a week: every release of the autonomous driving system was tested daily in the simulator and on vehicles.
- Set up from scratch simulator testing, delivery robot testing and embedded systems testing, from intermediate control units to lidars.
- Took part in launching sites in Innopolis, Skolkovo, Moscow, Tel Aviv and Yasenevo, and a commercial route on the M4 highway: from route planning to test processes for a safe launch.
- Prepared the first ride with nobody in the car: 50 km around Innopolis in October 2023, recorded under Russia's experimental legal regime.
- Put the first cars with no driver behind the wheel on Moscow roads and launched the robotaxi in Yasenevo.

May 2010 — May 2018

Testing, infrastructure and technical support

QIWI, Moscow-Paris Bank, Smolensky Bank, MKB • Moscow

- QIWI (2017–2018): ran system testing, wrote test cases and automated tests, took part in releases.
- Moscow-Paris Bank (2014–2017): responsible for servers, VPN and the ATM and terminal network.
- Smolensky Bank (2012–2014): led a technical support department of 20 people.
- MKB (2010–2012): set up from scratch and maintained a payment terminal network.

Core Skills

Leadership: QA Leadership, Team Management, Release Management, KPI & Metrics

Testing: Test Automation, pytest, Playwright, Vitest, E2E / Smoke, Simulation Testing, ADAS Testing, Factory Acceptance Testing, Regression Testing, Functional Testing, Autonomous Driving

Robotics and embedded: ESP32, GD32, ESP-IDF, MicroPython, BLE, ROS, MuJoCo

AI and machine learning: LLM (llama.cpp, vLLM), RAG, Fine-tuning / LoRA, TinyML / TFLite

Engineering and infrastructure: Python, SQL, Django, React, Bash, Docker Compose, CI/CD, Git, Linux, KVM / VMware / Proxmox, Jira

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Languages

- Russian — native
- English — B1 (professional use)

Education

- Volga State Academy of Telecommunications and Informatics, Applied Informatics in Economics — higher education, 2014
- College of Computing and Electronics, Software for Computer Systems — vocational diploma, 2008

Additional Information

- Driving license, categories A and B; own car
- Open to business trips and launching new sites

Projects and press

Yandex, October 2023

Innopolis: the first ride with nobody in the car

A self-driving car covered 50 km around the city with no safety driver inside. The ride was recorded under the experimental legal regime and opened the final stage of testing.

Inkazan: 50 km around Innopolis with no safety driver
Interfax: Yandex begins testing self-driving cars with no driver inside

Yandex, August 2023

Moscow, Yasenevo: rides with no driver behind the wheel

A new stage of testing in Yasenevo: the test engineer moved from the driver's seat to the passenger seat and can stop the car with a single E-stop button. The launch was prepared by the testing department; in Yandex's video I explain how this stage works.

Yandex on Instagram: video about the launch with no driver behind the wheel
Yandex: robotaxi launch in Moscow
Rozetked: Yandex begins testing a taxi with no driver behind the wheel

Yandex Education, 2026

Yandex Education Cup

A competition in programming courier robots, March 2026. The Cup was prepared by Yandex Education and its partners; my part was the robot software, the participant platform and the simulator. The code is open on GitHub.

Code on GitHub

Own project, 2026

Am I OK

Your whole health picture in one place: the service brings lab results, tracker data and habits together, and AI turns them into clear recommendations, quests and a step-by-step plan.

amiok.pro

ATOM, 2024–2025

ATOM autopilot on the Moscow–Kazan highway

A test vehicle with the driver assistance system covered 732 km, 95% of it with no operator input.

Auto.ru: autopilot tested on the Moscow–Kazan highway

RoboFinist, October 2026

Robo-Delivery: City Mission

A competition for students aged 12–15: a courier robot picks up a parcel, delivers it to an address and returns while following the road rules. Together with Yandex Education and RoboFinist we prepared the rules, the field, the judging criteria and a reference solution; I took part in the judging. The final took place on October 3, 2026 in Kronstadt. Photos: Lana Khalyavina.

RoboFinist: competition page